DSEH004 Performance Management and Employee Engagement

Week 7 | Lecture 3 | Unit III

Implementation Architectures

Champions networks, hybrid work, recovery and the line between listening and surveillance

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Commit before theory

Your firm wants daily engagement data from laptops: keystrokes, meeting load and sentiment in chat. What is the biggest risk?

A

Cost of the software

B

Employees see it as control, which damages the engagement it measures

C

Data will be too noisy to use

D

Managers will ignore the data

Engagement champions: how ideas actually spread

1 Opinion leaders

Rogers (2003): adoption spreads through respected peers more than through formal announcements

2 Selection

Choose champions for informal influence, not for seniority or volunteering alone

3 Two-way role

Champions carry messages down and bring problems up; one-way champions become messengers

What hybrid work does to engagement

Mechanism	Evidence	Design response
Autonomy	Telecommuting relates to higher perceived autonomy (Gajendran and Harrison, 2007)	Give control over when and where, with clear outcomes
Relationships	High-intensity telecommuting relates to weaker coworker relationships	Protect anchor days for collaboration and mentoring
Manager relationship	Telecommuting is not generally harmful to the supervisor relationship	Keep regular one-to-one conversations
Career visibility	Less face time can reduce informal sponsorship	Make contribution visible through outcomes

Recovery: engagement needs switching off

1 Detachment

Mentally switching off from work

2 Relaxation

Low activation and calm

3 Mastery

Challenging experiences outside work

4 Control

Choosing how to spend free time

Sonnentag and Fritz (2007): four recovery experiences; always-on hybrid work erodes detachment first

Listening or surveillance?

Listening

- Purpose explained and limited
- Aggregate data, protected identity
- Employees see results and actions
- Used for development

vs

Surveillance

- Purpose vague or expanding
- Individual tracking by default
- Results flow only upward
- Used for control and discipline

Ravid et al. (2020) and Ball (2010): electronic monitoring effects depend on purpose, transparency and how data are used

An implementation architecture

Sponsor

A leader who owns the outcome and protects time and budget

Managers

Equipped and measured on team conversations, not on scores

Champions

Peers who translate, adapt and report back

Feedback loop

Results shared with teams and acted on visibly

Hybrid at a Hyderabad captive center

Teaching case (Course framing)

A global capability center lets staff choose office days. A year later, engagement is up for experienced staff and down for new joiners, who say they learn slowly and do not know senior colleagues. Leaders propose a sentiment tool on chat channels to spot disengaged staff early.

Work it through

1. Explain the split using autonomy and relationship mechanisms
2. What should anchor days be used for?
3. Evaluate the sentiment tool using the listening versus surveillance test
4. Design a champions role for new joiners

Exam-style question

Evaluate the claim that hybrid work raises engagement. Use evidence on autonomy, relationships and recovery, and propose an implementation architecture. (20 marks)

What a strong answer does

- Uses Gajendran and Harrison to separate benefits and costs
- Uses Sonnentag and Fritz to discuss recovery and always-on work
- Distinguishes listening from surveillance with Ravid et al.
- Proposes sponsor, manager, champion and feedback roles

Sources

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